Famous: Princes, Prizes and Heroes

Day 1 · Reading (1 of 2)

What to do: Read it aloud, one paragraph each. Stop at every blue word: can anybody explain it?

Vocabulary topic: Famous people, kings and princes
20 new words (in blue) · EEW 1, Unit 7 · read about famous people and talk about leaders and challenges



easy parts harder parts (most new words are here)

Who is **famous** in your country? Ask ten people and you hear ten names: a singer, a football player, a king from history. Fame is strange. Some famous people we know very well, and some we know only by their name. A fun fact: the word “famous” comes from an old Latin word that means “talk”. A famous person is simply a person people talk about.

What makes a person famous? Experts say that there are three things: a talent, a good story and a little luck. Many famous people **contribute** something to the world: a song, a discovery or a new idea. But fame can be a heavy weight. A **sudden** success often brings a big **challenge**: everybody watches you, and you have no private life. Many young stars say they did not have the **sense** of how difficult it can be.

Some people become famous when they are very young. Malala Yousafzai, a girl from Pakistan, was only 17 when she won the Nobel Peace Prize in 2014. She is the youngest winner in history. She spoke about school for girls, and the world listened. That is the power of a clear voice and a brave heart.

In Samarkand, one of the most interesting **princes** in history was Ulugh Beg, the grandson of Timur. In the 1420s he built a big observatory, and with his team he made a catalog of more than 1,000 stars. It was so exact that scientists used it for hundreds of years. Some historians **claim** that he was a better scientist than a ruler. His family could not **divide** the power in **peace**, and in the end his own son rebelled against him. Today people remember the scientist, not the war.

In your book, Unit 7, a king is very sick. He must **announce** which of his three sons will be king. Two sons are strong, but the king chooses the third son, because he is kind. The story asks an old question: what is better for a country, a strong leader or a kind leader?

Famous: Princes, Prizes and Heroes

Day 1 · Reading (2 of 2)

What to do: After reading: which paragraphs were easy, which were hard? Which blue words did you know already?

A good leader must **protect** the people and not **harm** them. In the old days many rulers used **force**. Today a leader needs the trust of the people. There is a big **difference** between a king who is afraid of his people and a king who listens to them. A country that **allows** people to speak is in a better **condition** than a country that says nothing. Sometimes a leader must **lay** down the sword and listen.

Do you know how a king chose his heir in many countries? The oldest son usually became the next king. But history has many exceptions, and often the second or the third son was the better ruler. The best ruler is not always the strongest person in the family.

Fame today travels faster than ever. A video can reach a million people in one night, and an unknown person can be famous the next morning. Experts call this “viral fame”. It is exciting, but it can also be a burden, because the internet never forgets. A joke from a school party can follow a person for many years.

Think about your teachers, your doctors and your firefighters. They protect and help other people every day. They are not famous, but they are very important.

Some people say that being famous is the same as being **expert** at something. It is not. Fame is a number of people who know your name. Skill is a number of problems that you can solve. A true expert is a person you trust, even if nobody knows the name. Therefore, the best question is not “How can I become famous?” but “What can I do well, and how can I help?”

The 20 words

Day 1 · Vocabulary table · Topic: Famous people, kings and princes

What to do: Book: 4000 EEW 1, Unit 7, pages 44–47. Copy the words you do not know into the copybook.

Word	Meaning	По-русски	Example
allow v.	let someone do something	разрешать	My parents allow me to stay up late on Fridays.
announce v.	tell everybody something officially	объявлять	The school announced the winners.
beside prep.	next to	рядом с	Sit beside me.
challenge n.	something difficult that tests you	вызов, трудная задача	Climbing a mountain is a big challenge.
claim v.	say that something is true (without proof)	утверждать	He claims he can speak five languages.
condition n.	the state of something; a thing that must happen first	состояние	The car is in good condition.
contribute v.	give something to help	вносить вклад	Everybody contributed to the party.
difference n.	the way two things are not the same	разница	What is the difference between a frog and a toad?
divide v.	split into parts	делить	We divided the cake into eight pieces.
expert n.	a person with a lot of knowledge about something	эксперт, специалист	She is an expert on computers.
famous adj.	known by many people	знаменитый	Samarkand is a famous city.
force n./v.	power; to make someone do something	сила; заставлять	Don't use force: ask nicely.
harm n./v.	hurt or damage	вред; вредить	The sun can harm your skin.
lay v.	put something down carefully	класть	Lay the book on the table.
peace n.	a time without war	мир, покой	People want peace, not war.
prince n.	the son of a king or queen	принц	The prince lived in a big palace.
protect v.	keep safe from harm	защищать	A helmet protects your head.
sense n.	a feeling; the ability to understand	чувство; смысл	He has a good sense of humor.
sudden adj.	quick and not expected	внезапный	There was a sudden noise.
therefore adv.	so, for this reason	поэтому, следовательно	It was raining; therefore, we stayed home.

More on the topic

Day 1 · Topic: Famous people, kings and princes · more words

What to do: Choose 5 collocations to learn. Use the reserve words when a student already knows the main ones.

Collocations: words that go together

a famous singer · a world-famous artist	известный певец · всемирно известный артист
face a challenge	столкнуться с трудностью
contribute to…	вносить вклад в…
make an announcement	сделать объявление
keep the peace	сохранять мир
protect the environment	защищать окружающую среду
a big difference	большая разница
divide into groups	разделиться на группы
a sudden change	внезапная перемена
in good condition	в хорошем состоянии
do no harm	не причинять вреда
an expert on…	эксперт по…

Phrasal verbs

look up to	уважать, равняться на	Children look up to their teachers.
look down on	смотреть свысока	A good leader never looks down on people.
stand for	означать; отстаивать	What does UN stand for?
take over	взять на себя; захватить	The prince took over from his father.
give up	сдаться, бросить	He never gave up his dream.
carry out	выполнять	The team carried out the plan.

Reserve words: for students who know the 20 already, or if you prefer another word

king	король	**hero**	герой
queen	королева	**leader**	лидер
crown	корона	**rule**	править; правило
palace	дворец	**brave**	храбрый
prize	приз, премия	**kind**	добрый

What to read next · 4000 Essential English Words

This week: **Book 1, Unit 7, “The Best Prince”**, pages 44–49. Next: **Unit 8, “How the Sun and the Moon Were Made”**, pages 50–55. About a family and a choice: **Unit 4, “The Dog’s Bell”**, pages 26–31.